

The Spanish Civil War

Teacher Guide

AI REFLECTION

Framework Selected: ESA

AI Reasoning: The ESA (Engage, Study, Activate) framework was selected because the Spanish Civil War is a topic deeply rooted in historical culture and reading comprehension. This framework allows for an initial emotional hook (Engage), a factual analysis of the historical data (Study), and a critical reflection on its modern implications (Activate).

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Identify the primary factions and international actors involved in the Spanish Civil War (*CCL, CC*)

Analyze the ideological differences between the Nationalists and the Republicans (*CC, CPSAA*)

Explain the impact of the conflict on Spanish society and its transition to a dictatorship (*CC, CCEC*)

WARMUP ACTIVITY (5-10 MINS)

Activity: Visual Analysis

STUDENT INSTRUCTIONS:

Setup: You are looking at a black-and-white mural filled with chaotic imagery: a screaming horse, a mother grieving over her child, and a figure trapped in a burning building.

Challenge: Identify which major 20th-century historical event this artwork represents and explain what message the artist was trying to communicate to the world about war.

Answer: Guernica by Pablo Picasso

Explanation: Picasso created this mural to protest the bombing of the town of Guernica during the Spanish Civil War, highlighting the suffering of civilians.

METHOD:

Picture Prediction

TEACHER SCRIPT:

Let's begin by looking at this famous image. I want you to look closely at the figures and the lack of color. (*Engages students' visual literacy and CC competence*). What do you think prompted an artist to paint such a scene of despair? This represents one of the most

significant and tragic periods in Spanish history.

INTRODUCTION / HOOK

(Optional Hook Skipped - Combined with Warm-up)

MAIN LESSON (DYNAMIC PHASES)

Engage: The Causes of the Conflict

To understand the Spanish Civil War (1936-1939), we must look at the polarized state of Spain in the early 20th century. The country was deeply divided between traditionalist forces and those seeking radical modernization. The Second Republic, established in 1931, introduced reforms regarding land ownership, education, and the power of the Church. These changes were welcomed by some but seen as a threat by conservative sectors of society, including the military and the land-owning elite. By 1936, this tension reached a breaking point, leading to a failed military coup that spiraled into a full-scale civil war. This was not just a local conflict; it was a 'rehearsal' for World War II, as it pitted democracy, communism, and anarchism against the rising tide of fascism in Europe.

Examples:

- The agrarian reforms that sought to redistribute land to poor peasants.
- The separation of Church and State, which removed religious education from public schools.
- The military uprising in July 1936 led by generals like Francisco Franco.

Study: The Factions and International Support

The war was fought between two main sides: the Republicans and the Nationalists. The Republicans (or Loyalists) supported the democratically elected government and consisted of a diverse group including socialists, communists, anarchists, and liberal democrats. They were supported by the Soviet Union and the International Brigades-volunteers from around the world. On the other side were the Nationalists (or Rebels), led by General Francisco Franco. This faction included the military, the Catholic Church, and conservative monarchists. They received significant military aid from Nazi Germany and Fascist Italy, which provided advanced weaponry and air support, such as the Condor Legion. The conflict was characterized by extreme violence on both sides, known as the 'Red Terror' and the 'White Terror,' and it served as a brutal ideological battlefield for the future of Europe. *(*Provides factual historical framework for CP and CC competencies*)*.

Examples:

- The International Brigades: approximately 35,000 volunteers from 50 countries who fought for the Republic.

- The Condor Legion: the German air force unit that carried out the bombing of Guernica.
- Key leaders: Manuel Azaña (Republicans) vs. Francisco Franco (Nationalists).

Activate: The End of the War and its Legacy

By 1939, the Nationalist forces achieved a decisive victory, leading to the end of the Republic and the beginning of Francisco Franco's nearly 40-year dictatorship. The war left Spain devastated, with hundreds of thousands of deaths and a similar number of people forced into exile. The aftermath was marked by intense repression of the losing side. In contemporary Spain, the memory of the war remains a sensitive and complex topic. The 'Law of Democratic Memory' is a modern legislative effort to address the legacy of the conflict, locate mass graves, and provide recognition to the victims. Understanding this period is crucial for grasping the modern political landscape of Spain and the importance of democratic stability. *(*Promotes critical thinking and CC competence regarding historical memory*)*

Examples:

- The 1939 victory parade in Madrid marking the official end of the conflict.
- The 'Valle de los Caídos' (Valley of the Fallen) as a controversial symbol of the dictatorship.
- The process of 'Desenterrando el pasado' (Unearthing the past) through modern archaeological excavations of mass graves.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY / GAME

Activity Details:

- **Title:** Propaganda and Perspective Analysis
- **Category:** Group Work
- **Materials:** Paper, pens, and the two printed slogans: 'No Pasaran' and 'Una, Grande y Libre'.

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Divide the class into small groups and assign each group one of the provided historical slogans.
- Analyze the slogan: 'No Pasaran' (They shall not pass) for the Republicans and 'Una, Grande y Libre' (One, Great and Free) for the Nationalists.
- Discuss what values or emotions each slogan was trying to evoke in the population during the war.

- Create a simple list of three reasons why a young person in 1936 might have been convinced by that specific slogan.
- Present your group's findings to the class to compare how both sides used language to mobilize supporters.

WRAP UP / CONCLUSION

METHOD:

Exit Ticket

Script: Why is it important for a modern democracy to remember and study the difficult parts of its history, like the Spanish Civil War?

SUGGESTED VIDEO

Title: Spanish Civil War(1936-1939) #historicbattles #facts #history #historyfacts #shortsfeed #romanempire

[Watch Video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=B-p0SE_AMuo](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=B-p0SE_AMuo)

Info: The Spanish Civil War was not just a battle between two sides-it was a collision of ideologies that reshaped world history forever. From the burning skies over Guernica to the streets soaked in fear and resistance, this war became the proving ground for the horrors of World War II. In this powerful cinematic narration, we uncover how Spain ...

The Spanish Civil War

4º ESO | English (CLIL) | CEFR B2

WARM-UP

Visual Analysis

Method: Picture Prediction

Setup:

You are looking at a black-and-white mural filled with chaotic imagery: a screaming horse, a mother grieving over her child, and a figure trapped in a burning building.

Challenge:

Identify which major 20th-century historical event this artwork represents and explain what message the artist was trying to communicate to the world about war.

Answer:

Guernica by Pablo Picasso

Picasso created this mural to protest the bombing of the town of Guernica during the Spanish Civil War, highlighting the suffering of civilians.

ENGAGE

The Causes of the Conflict

To understand the Spanish Civil War (1936-1939), we must look at the polarized state of Spain in the early 20th century. The country was deeply divided between traditionalist forces and those seeking radical modernization. The Second Republic, established in 1931, introduced reforms regarding land ownership, education, and the power of the Church.

EXAMPLES

1. The agrarian reforms that sought to redistribute land to poor peasants.
2. The separation of Church and State, which removed religious education from public schools.
3. The military uprising in July 1936 led by generals like Francisco Franco.

STUDY

The Factions and International Support

The war was fought between two main sides: the Republicans and the Nationalists. The Republicans (or Loyalists) supported the democratically elected government and consisted of a diverse group including socialists, communists, anarchists, and liberal democrats. They were supported by the Soviet Union and the International Brigades-volunteers from around the world.

EXAMPLES

1. The International Brigades: approximately 35,000 volunteers from 50 countries who fought for the Republic.
2. The Condor Legion: the German air force unit that carried out the bombing of Guernica.
3. Key leaders: Manuel Azaña (Republicans) vs. Francisco Franco (Nationalists).

ACTIVATE

The End of the War and its Legacy

By 1939, the Nationalist forces achieved a decisive victory, leading to the end of the Republic and the beginning of Francisco Franco's nearly 40-year dictatorship. The war left Spain devastated, with hundreds of thousands of deaths and a similar number of people forced into exile. The aftermath was marked by intense repression of the losing side.

EXAMPLES

1. The 1939 victory parade in Madrid marking the official end of the conflict.
2. The 'Valle de los Caídos' (Valley of the Fallen) as a controversial symbol of the dictatorship.
3. The process of 'Desenterrando el pasado' (Unearthing the past) through modern archaeological excavations of mass graves.

ACTIVITY

Propaganda and Perspective Analysis

Type: Group Work

Materials: Paper, pens, and the two printed slogans: 'No Pasaran' and 'Una, Grande y Libre'.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Divide the class into small groups and assign each group one of the provided historical slogans.
2. Analyze the slogan: 'No Pasaran' (They shall not pass) for the Republicans and 'Una, Grande y Libre' (One, Great and Free) for the Nationalists.
3. Discuss what values or emotions each slogan was trying to evoke in the population during the war.
4. Create a simple list of three reasons why a young person in 1936 might have been convinced by that specific slogan.
5. Present your group's findings to the class to compare how both sides used language to

mobilize supporters.

Watch & Learn

Spanish Civil War(1936-1939 #historicbattles #facts #history #historyfacts #shortsfeed
#romanempire

[Click to Watch Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=B-p0SE_AMuo)

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PRACTICE TIME

Time for Worksheets!

Now let's apply your knowledge with some practice exercises!

REFLECTION



Why is it important for a modern democracy to remember and study the difficult parts of its history, like the Spanish Civil War?

Take a moment to think about what you learned today.

The Spanish Civil War

Worksheet (L1 Support)

Name: _____

Year Level: _____ Section: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Complete the following exercises to reinforce your understanding.

QUESTIONS

1. Match the historical term or figure on the left with its correct description on the right.

Francisco Franco	_____	A. The general who led the Nationalist forces
Republicans	_____	B. The faction supporting the democratically elected government
1936	_____	C. The year the Spanish Civil War began
International Brigades	_____	D. Foreign volunteers who fought for the Republic
Nationalists	_____	E. The conservative faction supported by Germany and Italy

2. Complete the sentences about the conflict using the words provided: Guernica, dictatorship, Soviet Union, Germany, three.

1. The Spanish Civil War lasted for _____ years.
2. The town of _____ was bombed by the German air force.
3. The Republicans received military aid from the _____.
4. The Nationalists received help from Italy and _____.
5. After the war, Spain became a _____ under General Franco.

The Spanish Civil War

Answer Key (L1 (Support))

ANSWER KEY - L1 (SUPPORT)

1. Match the historical term or figure on the left with its correct description on the right.

- a. Francisco Franco
- b. Republicans
- c. 1936
- d. International Brigades
- e. Nationalists

Options:

- A. The general who led the Nationalist forces
- B. The faction supporting the democratically elected government
- C. The year the Spanish Civil War began
- D. Foreign volunteers who fought for the Republic
- E. The conservative faction supported by Germany and Italy

Answer: Franco-General; Republicans-Government; 1936-Start; International Brigades-Volunteers; Nationalists-Conservative

2. Complete the sentences about the conflict using the words provided: Guernica, dictatorship, Soviet Union, Germany, three.

- 1. The Spanish Civil War lasted for _____ years.
- 2. The town of _____ was bombed by the German air force.
- 3. The Republicans received military aid from the _____.
- 4. The Nationalists received help from Italy and _____.
- 5. After the war, Spain became a _____ under General Franco.

Answer: three, Guernica, Soviet Union, Germany, dictatorship

The Spanish Civil War

Worksheet (L2 Standard)

Name: _____

Year Level: _____ Section: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer the following questions based on the lesson.

QUESTIONS

1. Imagine a friend from another country asks you why other nations like Germany and the Soviet Union got involved in a Spanish war. How would you explain it to them in 3-4 sentences?

2. Describe two major social or political changes introduced during the Second Republic that caused tension with conservative groups.

The Spanish Civil War

Answer Key (L2 (Standard))

ANSWER KEY - L2 (STANDARD)

1. Imagine a friend from another country asks you why other nations like Germany and the Soviet Union got involved in a Spanish war. How would you explain it to them in 3-4 sentences?

Possible Answers:

a. Spain became a testing ground for new military tactics and weapons. European powers saw the war as an ideological struggle between fascism and communism. Germany wanted to support a fellow nationalist leader, while the Soviet Union wanted to stop the spread of fascism. This involvement turned a local conflict into an international one (*Demonstrates understanding of international context and CC competence*).

2. Describe two major social or political changes introduced during the Second Republic that caused tension with conservative groups.

Possible Answers:

a. One change was the land reform that aimed to redistribute property from wealthy owners to poor farmers. Another was the secularization of education, which reduced the influence of the Catholic Church in schools. These changes angered the elite and the clergy, contributing to the start of the war (*Identifies cause-and-effect relationships and CP/CC competencies*).

The Spanish Civil War

Worksheet (L3 Advanced)

Name: _____

Year Level: _____ Section: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Analyze and solve the following advanced problems.

QUESTIONS/CHALLENGES

1. Analyze the role of art and propaganda during the Spanish Civil War. Using Picasso's 'Guernica' as an example, explain how art can influence international public opinion during a conflict.

2. Correct the historical inaccuracies in the following statement: 'The Spanish Civil War ended in 1945 when the Republicans, supported by Nazi Germany, defeated General Franco and established a long-lasting democracy.'

The Spanish Civil War

Answer Key (L3 (Advanced))

ANSWER KEY - L3 (ADVANCED)

1. Analyze the role of art and propaganda during the Spanish Civil War. Using Picasso's 'Guernica' as an example, explain how art can influence international public opinion during a conflict.

Possible Answers:

a. Art like Guernica serves as a powerful medium for highlighting civilian suffering, moving beyond military statistics. It humanizes victims and can turn international sentiment against the aggressors. By touring the painting globally, the Republic sought to gain sympathy and intervention from democratic nations, showing that art is a tool for political advocacy and historical record (*Analyzes CCEC and CC through high-level synthesis*).

2. Correct the historical inaccuracies in the following statement: 'The Spanish Civil War ended in 1945 when the Republicans, supported by Nazi Germany, defeated General Franco and established a long-lasting democracy.'

Possible Answers:

a. The war ended in 1939, not 1945. It was the Nationalists who were supported by Nazi Germany, not the Republicans. General Franco was the leader of the Nationalists and he was the one who won, establishing a dictatorship rather than a democracy (*Demonstrates advanced factual mastery and critical correction skills*).